



Apple making batteries?

Apple is contacting cobalt suppliers to lock in supplies contracts, seemingly to make Li-ion batteries for its smart car project. <http://digit.in/iBattery>



Smartphone sales down

For the first time since tracking the smartphone industry began, sales have dropped year-over-year. <http://digit.in/Smartslow>



>> Feedback for the February 2018 issue of Digit

Send your feedback at editor@digit.in

 Hey Digit and Agent 001...

I recently stumbled upon a video of Beebom on YouTube. In that video, they make a smart assistant with Google's Assistant and Amazon's Alexa built in. And what to say, I fell in love with that DIY project.

I am 100% interested in doing this project and making a smart 'HOME' device. But the problem that I'm facing is that the Raspberry Pi alone costs whopping ₹2,639 let alone the costs of other things like the wireless speaker and the microSD card.

So, I am asking you to please suggest me a cheaper alternative to the Raspberry Pi and the Wireless Speaker. Will the Pi Zero do?

—Kshipra Jadav

d Yes, the Pi Zero is capable of running the same project without any issues. In fact, if you check the Git Readme, you'll see that the author has provided the required modifications for when you have to use the Pi Zero. The model you've linked in the second video is the upgraded Pi Zero W which includes Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. That too, is capable of working with this DIY. The underlying Google Assistant, i.e. GassistPi is what does most of the work and that functions on all Raspberry Pi boards.

—Mithun

 Hi Team, I have been reading Digit since September 2016...

And since then became a huge fan of yours. I am working in oracle technology and would love to see fasttrack on Oracle the way you did with apple and Google. Amazing! Keep it up.

—Raj Rajpurkar

d Glad to know that you liked the tech ecosystem focussed FastTracks on Apple and Google. While they were chosen for their evident popularity, there are indeed other ecosystems that are equally, if not more, vast and complex and are truly worth exploring. Oracle, as you've rightly mentioned, is one of them. We'll add it to our list of FastTrack areas to cover.

—Arnab

 Greetings, team Digit!! This is my second time writing you guys. I could write 8-9 lines to appreciate the awestruckness (not a word, I know!) of your endeavor, but why state the obvious? Let's get to the point. I haven't had any complaints with the content of Digit and its attachments but lately I feel like the pocket marvel "Dmystify" is repeating itself. The content of some of the booklets are more or less the same. For example, take a look at dmystifys of "Fringe Science" and "Pseudoscience" or "Fossils" and "Geology and Dating". I

know Robert sir is doing his best and let me tell you, dmystify is a delightful experience. But I would appreciate if the upcoming Dmystifys didn't overlap.

—Abhishek Solanki

d While it is true that there was a repeat in some basic concepts and parts of the books you mentioned (no more than 5/6 pages, really), it's only because we are faced with the challenge of catering to regular readers such as yourself, and also to one time buyers who may not buy every issue, and thus may not have read the previous dmystifys. It's hard to just assume knowledge on every reader's behalf.

The only problem was that these are basics of science that we feel everyone should know, and our goal is one of making India more scientific minded, or at least encouraging scientific thinking in even those that did not take science as a stream in college.

That said, I do understand your complaint, and will certainly try to make the topics far more diverse in the future, so as to avoid any repetition whatsoever.

—Robert

 This was my first time reading Digit and my Mind is blown! What a great compilation of technology trends! But I do have one issue; the software and games provided in the DVD are compatible only with x64 windows. Unfortunately, I have x86 on all my systems. Please add both versions.

—Jatin Devnani

d We do try to include both x86 and x64 versions of software and games in our DVD. However, space is the problem. While it is possible for smaller file sizes, when some go into GBs of space, this is just not possible. These days everyone has 64-bit CPUs and OSes, and we find it safer to cater to the majority. Why not upgrade your software to 64-bit? It's worth it.

—Abhijit

 Hey there. First of all I wanna say I am big fan of digit and have been buying it since 2006. It's a really awesome technology magazine.